viii)Never Purchase from Black Market

The consumer should discharge his duties as responsible citizen. He should not buy things from black market and in excess of his requirements. At times of scarcity consumer should not resort to panic buying and stock things excessively. This practice prevents others from purchasing their share of requirement.

ix) Buying Standardized Products

Often the consumer buys cheap products which are not durable or are not safe. Therefore, it is the duty of the consumer to buy products with standardization marks which is supposed to be safe in every respect.

x) Follow the Instruction of the Manufacturer

It is the duty of the consumer to use the product as per its instructions, e.g., if a medicine carries an instruction regarding its storage, it should be stored in the fridge. This would help in prevention of any damage to the medicine and harm to the consumer's health.

xi) Knowledge of Consumer Rights

These days it is not uncommon to see a seller trying to cheat the consumer in every possible way in order to earn quick profits. It is the duty of the consumer to be aware of his rights. If a consumer is cheated by a seller, then he should immediately lodge a complaint with the authorities designated for consumer grievance redressal rather than remaining a silent spectator.

17.03 Responsibilities of Consumer

Consumer rights, by themselves, cannot be effective in achieving the objective of consumer protection. Consumer protection can, in effect, be achieved only when the consumers also understand their responsibilities. Consumers should keep in mind their responsibilities while purchasing, using and consuming goods and services. Rights and responsibilities are two sides of the same coin. Just as consumers enjoy certain rights, they owe certain responsibilities. The responsibilities of consumer are listed below;

1. The consumer must pay the price of the goods according to the terms and conditions of the sales contract.
2. The consumer has got a responsibility to apply to the seller for the delivery of the goods. He/she has to take delivery of the goods in time.
3. The consumer has to bear any loss, which may arise to the seller when the consumer delays taking delivery of the goods as per the terms of contract.
4. The consumer is bound to pay any interest and special damages caused to the seller in case if there is delay in the payment.
5. The consumer has to assiduously follow and keenly observe the instructions and precautions while using the products.
6. The consumer has the responsibility to express unambiguously to the seller of his requirements and expectations from the product.
7. The consumer must seek to collect complete information about the quality, quantity, price etc of the product before purchasing it.
8. The consumer must get cash receipt as a proof of goods purchased from the seller. If it carries any warranty, the buyer must obtain the warranty card mentioning the date of purchase and period of warranty. It must also bear the signature and stamp of the seller organisation.
9. The consumer must file a complaint with the seller concerned about defects or shortcomings noticed in their products and services.
10. The consumer should never compromise on the quality of goods. The consumers must watch for ISI, Agmark, FPO, the standard quality certification marks and the like in the label.

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